detection but only got suspicious about surveillance at his residence about two weeks before his escape. A R&AW surveillance team was deployed at his residence 24/7. His car and house were bugged. The R&AW officer handling the team believes that Rabinder had asked an officer in the security unit to sweep his office. This, he thinks, was proof of Rabinder's suspicion that he was being monitored. The R&AW officer requested the then National Security Advisor Brajesh Mishra to sign the order for Rabinder's arrest. But Mishra kept delaying the matter. It appears he wanted to get rid of Rabinder anyhow or perhaps waited for him to disappear because the existence of a CIA mole deep inside the R&AW was nothing less than a coup. He asked for more evidence and details of Rabinder's handlers in the US. This was a huge mistake. The capture and subsequent interrogation of Rabinder Singh could have unravelled the CIA network in India and Nepal as well as other moles or facilitators if there were any.

The night Rabinder Singh fled to Nepal, the surveillance team posted at his residence had spotted his wife leaving the house. She then came back with a family friend. Rabinder was in the house. The friend left after dinner. The team never saw Rabinder and his wife leaving the house. They only learned of the couple's escape the next day when there was no activity in the house and the spotters panicked. When an officer barged into the house on the pretext of delivering office circulars, the family servant disclosed that Sahib and Memsahib have gone to Punjab for a wedding. This was the last lie Rabinder Singh uttered before he vanished.

According to R&AW officers, neither Rabinder's wife nor his children were aware that Rabinder was a double agent. For them, he was a senior officer in the Cabinet Secretariat.